

**Standing Committee on Student Learning Assessment (SCSLA)**  
**General Education Subcommittee**  
**Minutes for Thursday, December 01, 2011**

**Present:** Jeff Jurik, Steve Call, Mary Woestman

Answers to Questions for SUNY raised at the last meeting:

1. Is the Memorandum to the Board of Trustees from Chancellor Zimmerman the same as BOT Resolution 2010-39? According to the link provided in an email from Nancy Willie-Schiff, the assessment point person at SUNY, they are one and the same.
2. Has an advisory group for assessment been formed and if so, how do we contact them? Again, from Nancy W-S, yes, there is an advisory group co-chaired by Norayne Rosero at MVCC ([nrosoero@mvcc.edu](mailto:nrosoero@mvcc.edu)) and Michael Christakis at U Albany ([mchristakis@uamail.albany.edu](mailto:mchristakis@uamail.albany.edu)). She also suggests that we follow the SUNY assessment list-serve and submit questions and requests for advice to the list. To join the list, send a request to [Diane.VanDenburg@suny.edu](mailto:Diane.VanDenburg@suny.edu). Further assistance is available on the SUNY Assessment web site's "Other Links" section at [http://www.suny.edu/provost/academic\\_affairs/assessment.cfm](http://www.suny.edu/provost/academic_affairs/assessment.cfm). AAC&U's LEAP program focuses on general education, and its VALUE rubrics provide model assessment tools, while the Internet Resources site at <http://www2.acs.ncsu.edu/UPA/assmt/resource.htm> is a well organized compendium of resources.
3. Is the process for getting approved courses on the Provost's list the same as it has been? i.e. do all courses have to be submitted to SUNY in order to be considered as meeting the GEN ED requirement? This time the answer comes from Debbie Moeckel, Assistant Provost for Community College Education. She says, "The process is indeed the same as it has been. Local approval is actually required first, but we need to have the final review so that we can ensure consistency across the university, and so that we can update our records for campuses to have the most current references to validate transfer information with regard to gen ed."

The first two questions we raised for ourselves at the last meeting are still questions:

1. What external review is in place for service departments that do not have programs? What would be appropriate for departments if there is no current process?
2. Are the plans for IE, SLA and GE currently summarized in document form or organized in such a way that the plan is obvious?

The third question has been answered:

3. Will we have a joint meeting with IEAC this semester? Yes. It will be on December 16<sup>th</sup> at 11 in W203B.

With regard to the general education assessment itself, the committee agreed to formulate a recommendation to the VPAA that a standing subcommittee of the BCC Curriculum Committee be formed to grant local approval to courses seeking to be considered for fulfilling the SUNY GE requirement and to facilitate forwarding the addition template to SUNY for review. Mary will contact Sandy Wright (CC chair) to give her a heads up that this is coming.

Next meeting: TBD

## **MEMO**

**To:** Julie Peacock, VPAA

**From:** Mary Woestman, Chair of Standing Committee on Student Learning Assessment

**Date:** December 2, 2011

**Re:** Local Approval of General Education Courses.

In revisiting the College's General Education Assessment Procedures, the SCSLA has become aware that the responsibility for locally approving courses for SUNY General Education credit currently resides with the individual departments planning to offer the courses. In the past, this function was the responsibility of the General Education Steering Committee. We feel that there is merit in having a college level committee review the potential additions to the General Education curriculum and are recommending that the tradition be revived. By having departments submit their requests directly to SUNY, the college faculty is, in effect, giving over local control of the BCC general education curriculum to SUNY central, a concept that we find untenable.

One way to effect the change we seek would be to have a structure parallel to the GE assessment structure. That is, since we have a subcommittee of SCSLA that is responsible for the GE assessment, we would like to see a subcommittee of the BCC Curriculum Committee take responsibility for the GE curriculum. The functions of the committee may include:

- To insure that the proposer(s) has included the SUNY learning outcomes for the particular knowledge and skill area within the course learning outcomes, is planning learning activities related to those outcomes, and has a plan for assessment that meets our accreditation needs.
- To review the SUNY GER Course Addition form which course proposers would also submit to the committee.
- To give local approval for the course to be added to the General Education Curriculum and forward the documents to the assistant to the VPAA to be sent forward to SUNY.
- To review and approve courses submitted for local General Education credit.
- To institute any changes in the General Education learning outcomes or requirements that may become necessary going forward.
- To be a repository for all information regarding the BCC General Education requirements and curriculum.

Note: In a recent email correspondence between the chair of SCSLA and Deborah Moeckel, the Assistant Provost for Community College Education, Dr. Moeckel confirmed that the process for getting SUNY GE course approval requires local approval first.

Friday, September 25, 2026

M. Woestman